

E-mail Etiquette Guidelines

- Use an appropriate subject header.
- Start with "Dear Mr./Ms." and the recipient's name spelled correctly.
- Introduce yourself early and state your purpose for writing.
- Be professional / positive and more formal than with friends.
- Avoid strange fonts, distractions at the bottom of your messages.
- Keep your message brief; don't ask too many questions or ramble on.
- Proofread your message!
- Write your full name to "sign".

Text Etiquette Guidelines for the Workplace!

The use of instant message, typically referred to as IM or texting can save a lot of time at work. If you need to ask a quick question or send a response, you can send them an IM to get a quick response. Despite its ease and quickness, we should still be respectful of basic etiquette guidelines when using IM at work.

1. **You should know the person.** - You should have met the person, not just know them from social media.
2. **Start with a short greeting.** - When starting a conversation you should always say "hi" or "hello" and then check it's a good time for them to chat.
3. **Be mindful of the receiver's preferred style of communication.** - Adjust your style of communication to meet the other person's, whether they are colleagues, bosses, customers, or clients.
4. **Keep the conversation short.** - Ask yourself, will this message require the receiver to take time to think about their response? If yes, you might want to send an email or call them instead.
5. **Be careful with abbreviations.** - It's common to use abbreviations and shortcuts such as "LOL" (laugh out loud), "np" (no problem), or "u" (you) in an IM, but make sure the abbreviation you use is appropriate. Make sure people know what you're talking about.
6. **Never send bad news via IM.** - IM is too casual a way to have an important conversation.
7. **Don't change meeting times or venues in an IM.** - If you're going to change a meeting time or venue at the last minute, give the person a call out of respect.
8. **Be aware of a status message.** - Do not send someone an online chat if their status is "away" or "busy."
9. **End conversations with a short closing.** - Once the conversation ends, say "thanks" or "thank you," It's rude not to respond.
10. **Don't text everywhere** - many places are inappropriate to text (e.g., meeting, at a dinner table, performance, etc.).
11. **Err on the side of formal (at work)** - When typing a text use full words and sentences.